

## Lessen Shame and Fear by Admitting Your Wrongs

Many people enter Overcomer/Recovery with a lot of [secrets](#), shame, and fear—fear of people finding out what they’ve done in the past, fear of moving forward in a life without indulging in the vice they struggle with, and fear of just surviving in this new world they’re trying to create for themselves. Often, the shame that many people feel as they’re actively working on their struggle makes it more difficult. Many people struggling with substance misuse do things they would never do sober: lie, steal, cheat, and other things typically not in line with who they are or want to be. It is the same with everything people struggle with.

This can cause a person to feel a lot of shame, which can result in getting stuck in a cycle of living in/with that struggle. A person feels shame, and one of the easiest ways they know how to combat that shame is to sink back into that thing they are wanting to overcome. In continuing to indulge, the undesired behaviors may also continue, and this just adds to the shame. It’s a vicious—though understandable—cycle that is difficult to break free from. Sharing your struggles and admitting your wrongs to another person can help you put everything into perspective and you can begin to forgive yourself. [Research shows](#) that self-forgiveness protocols reduced feelings of guilt and shame. Additionally, self-forgiveness protocols help promote and maintain decreased alcohol misuse and abstinence. For many people, sharing your Step 4 (Self examination) work with another person can act as a [self-forgiveness tool](#) and often results in the same benefits: less shame and increased abstinence.